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Fitchburg Common Council votes to end Flock Safety camera contact

Jake Eichstaedt
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File photo

FITCHBURG, Wis. (WKOW) -- The Common Council of Fitchburg voted unanimously Tuesday to discontinue its contract with Flock Safety and the use of the traffic cameras.

Flock Safety cameras help local police locate suspects or missing persons by identifying a vehicle's make and model. According to their website, has helped locate more than 10,000 missing people in the last year, had their technology used in over 1

million court cases, and were operating in 12,000 communities nationwide.

However, residents spoke for nearly 45 minutes before the vote, voicing concerns of privacy and how accessible data from the cameras is to outside agencies.

The fight against Flock transcends Fitchburg: In 2026 alone, Dane County ended their contract with Flock, going against the county's Sheriff, Calvin Barrett's concerns; and UW-Madison academic staff also oppose of the university's use of the plate reader cameras. Many other communities in Wisconsin have made the same decision recently, like Verona, Appleton, and Oshkosh. Just this month, there are accusations of law enforcement misusing the technology to spy on a former romantic interest. That officer has pleaded not guilty, but did resign from the Milwaukee Police Department.

Jake Eichstaedt

Anchor

Jake Eichstaedt comes to the WKOW 27 News team after working a plethora of positions in other newsrooms. Beginning in Texas and moving to North Carolina, his broadcast experience range includes reporting, producing, directing, photogging, sports reporting, hosting, anchoring and even selling ad space. Although he can wear many hats, he is excited to instead comb his hair to be behind the anchor desk.